



Say It Yourself

WisdomForge Booklet — Ages 5–10

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About This Book

This is not a phrasebook and it is not an app. A talking tool already speaks every tongue you can name. This booklet teaches a slower thing: a mouth that moves before any speaker in a phone.

WisdomForge already has language Hour books when Michael drops them. Those are a different product. This booklet sits beside the six *Voice* sittings: Say It Yourself; Hear, Then Say; One Phrase That Is Yours; Ask Out Loud; Catch the Ghost-Speaker; and Speak First Capstone. Those sittings are live. This booklet is those six, told as one story you can hold.

You will hear Wilhelm von Humboldt on language as activity, not a finished work. You will hear lines from the academy sittings. Those lines are ours. We do not pretend a Stoic said them.

Each chapter has a story, words to remember, a big idea, something to try with a living mouth, and a question for the table. Phones wait. The person in the room is the judge.

Grown-ups: you are in the room. You do not need to be fluent. Your mouth next to theirs matters more than a perfect accent model.

Chapter 1: Your Mouth Has to Move



Illustration for Chapter 1

Ears first. Mouth second. That is not a slogan. It is a house rule.

A talking tool can say a word in any tongue. Pretty sound is not practice. Practice is air leaving your own mouth. In the academy sitting *Say It Yourself* (‘say-it-yourself’), the tool may be a second listen. It may not speak instead of you.

A grown-up says one phrase. Hello. Thank you. A food. The child says it. They say it together. They say it alone. Then, if a grown-up agrees, a guide may be heard once. Then mute. Say it again.

Wilhelm von Humboldt wrote that language is not a finished work (*ergon*) but an activity (*energeia*). A model gives you *ergon* — a finished object. Your mouth is *energeia*. If you only collect finished objects, you have stickers, not a tongue.

Do not mock accent. Shy mouths still move in this house, a little. You will be silly together.

A phrase on a screen is a sticker. A phrase you say when you want water is yours.

If a tool starts to talk to a person for the child, stop it. Whose mouth was it?

A grown-up stays in the room. Five to ten does not run this arc alone with a model.

Words to Remember

*"Language is not a product (*ergon*) but an activity (*energeia*)." — Wilhelm von Humboldt, *On Language* (1836)*

*"If your mouth didn't move, you didn't practice." — WisdomForge sitting *Say It Yourself**

Big Idea

Ears first. Mouth second. The target is a human ear, not a fluent waveform.

Try This

1. Pick one phrase. A grown-up says it. The child says it twice. Use it for real (please, thank you, hello). Tool last. 2. Ask a grown-up: whose mouth moved? 3. If a speaker tries to take the turn, stop it.

Ask a Grown-Up

What word did we actually say today in another tongue?

Chapter 2: One Phrase That Is Yours



Illustration for Chapter 2

Used, not displayed. That is not a slogan. It is a house rule.

A talking tool can say a word in any tongue. Pretty sound is not practice. Practice is air leaving your own mouth. In the academy sitting *One Phrase That Is Yours* (one-phrase-yours), the tool may be a second listen. It may not speak instead of you.

A grown-up says one phrase. Hello. Thank you. A food. The child says it. They say it together. They say it alone. Then, if a grown-up agrees, a guide may be heard once. Then mute. Say it again.

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Ask a Grown-Up

What word did we actually say today in another tongue?

Chapter 3: Ask Out Loud



Illustration for Chapter 3

A question you can say is language. That is not a slogan. It is a house rule.

A talking tool can say a word in any tongue. Pretty sound is not practice. Practice is air leaving your own mouth. In the academy sitting *Ask Out Loud* ('ask-out-loud'), the tool may be a second listen. It may not speak instead of you.

A grown-up says one phrase. Hello. Thank you. A food. The child says it. They say it together. They say it alone. Then, if a grown-up agrees, a guide may be heard once. Then mute. Say it again.

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Try This

1. Pick one phrase. A grown-up says it. The child says it twice. Use it for real (please, thank you, hello). Tool last. 2. Ask a grown-up: whose mouth moved? 3. If a speaker tries to take the turn, stop it.

Ask a Grown-Up

What word did we actually say today in another tongue?

Chapter 4: Catch the Ghost-Speaker



Illustration for Chapter 4

A tool must not take your turn. That is not a slogan. It is a house rule.

A talking tool can say a word in any tongue. Pretty sound is not practice. Practice is air leaving your own mouth. In the academy sitting *Catch the Ghost-Speaker* (‘catch-the-ghost-speaker’), the tool may be a second listen. It may not speak instead of you.

A grown-up says one phrase. Hello. Thank you. A food. The child says it. They say it together. They say it alone. Then, if a grown-up agrees, a guide may be heard once. Then mute. Say it again.

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1. Pick one phrase. A grown-up says it. The child says it twice. Use it for real (please, thank you, hello). Tool last. 2. Ask a grown-up: whose mouth moved? 3. If a speaker tries to take the turn, stop it.

Ask a Grown-Up

What word did we actually say today in another tongue?

Chapter 5: Mouth First, Then the Tool



Illustration for Chapter 5

The pile is a person. The judge is still a mouth. That is not a slogan. It is a house rule.

A talking tool can say a word in any tongue. Pretty sound is not practice. Practice is air leaving your own mouth. In the academy sitting *Mouth First, Then the Tool* (‘speak-first-capstone’), the tool may be a second listen. It may not speak instead of you.

A grown-up says one phrase. Hello. Thank you. A food. The child says it. They say it together. They say it alone. Then, if a grown-up agrees, a guide may be heard once. Then mute. Say it again.

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Ask a Grown-Up

What word did we actually say today in another tongue?

Humboldt's distinction still holds when we say it again: the product on the screen is not the activity in the mouth. The sitting says the tool may listen second. It may not speak instead. A house that never speaks will not get a language from an app. (1)

Humboldt's distinction still holds when we say it again: the product on the screen is not the activity in the mouth. The sitting says the tool may listen second. It may not speak instead. A house that never speaks will not get a language from an app. (2)

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